Daniel Okafor-Reyes

Backend Engineer | Java, Kotlin, Python (scripting)

Contact

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Professional Summary

Backend engineer with professional experience building and operating Java and Kotlin services, REST APIs, and event-driven systems. Experienced with PostgreSQL, Kafka, automated testing, Docker, and AWS services including EKS, S3, and SQS. Has improved service reliability through idempotent Kafka consumers, transactional outbox implementation, and production incident response. Interested in moving toward a Python- or Go-based stack; Python experience to date is limited to scripts and small Jenkins helpers, not production services.

Technical Skills

Languages: Java, Kotlin; Python scripting; Go (learning; personal CLI project)
Backend and APIs: Spring Boot, REST API design, OpenAPI 3
Databases and messaging: PostgreSQL, Oracle, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Redis
Testing and delivery: Testcontainers, Spring Cloud Contract, Docker, Jenkins helper scripting
Cloud and platforms: Kubernetes, AWS EKS, S3, SQS

Professional Experience

Backend Engineer | Tejo Insurance Tech *2022–Present*

- Build and support Java and Kotlin Spring Boot microservices, including REST APIs and Kafka-based services.
- Designed a versioned OpenAPI 3 REST API for insurance brokers; rate limiting and contract tests supported onboarding 12 partners handling approximately 400,000 quote requests per month.
- Resolved duplicate claim records caused by at-least-once Kafka delivery by implementing the transactional outbox pattern and idempotency keys for consumers. Duplicate claims fell from approximately 40 per week to zero over the following quarter.
- Developed an internal Kotlin and Spring Boot service to render policy PDFs from templates; wrote the company's first Kotlin service guidelines.
- Participate in the on-call rota, one week per month. Handled a major Kafka lag incident in March 2024; the incident write-up was praised.
- Run the backend guild meeting every two weeks, a responsibility held since 2024.
- Work in English in a 100% English-speaking work environment.
- Use AWS EKS, S3, and SQS as a service user; can read Terraform but have not written Terraform modules.

Software Developer | Viajar Online *2019–2021*

- Worked on booking and payments in a large Java application using Oracle.
- Raised payments-module test coverage from 35% to 70% using Testcontainers, enabling safer refactoring.
- Extracted email and SMS notifications from the booking monolith into a separate Spring Boot service, using RabbitMQ for messaging and Thymeleaf for templating.

Selected Personal Project

OpenAPI Specification Diff CLI | Go | Personal project

- Building a command-line tool to compare OpenAPI specifications as part of learning Go.
- Approximately 600 lines of code; available on GitHub. Personal project, not production software.

Certification

Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE 11 Developer | *2020*